The Circulatory System

The circulatory system consists of the

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Its function is to transport various substances around the body. These are

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Blood

The human body has about _____ litres of blood. Human blood is made of four components; plasma, red blood cells, white blood cells and platelets.

Plasma

Plasma is the main component of blood, consisting mainly of _____ . It is pale _____ in colour. Plasma carries _____ _____ , _____ and _____ . Suspended in the plasma are the _____ and ____ blood cells and _____ .

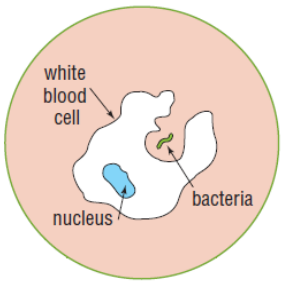
Red Blood Cells



Red blood cells carry _____ throughout the body. Oxygen combines with an _____ containing chemical called _____ in the blood cells. Red blood cells are _____ shaped and do not have a _____ .

White Blood Cells

White blood cells are _____ and _____ _____ than red blood cells. They have ___ _____ _____ , but possess a _____ . White blood cells are mostly involved in _____ _____ . They protect the body from disease by 'eating' _____ _____ and _____ in the blood.



Platelets

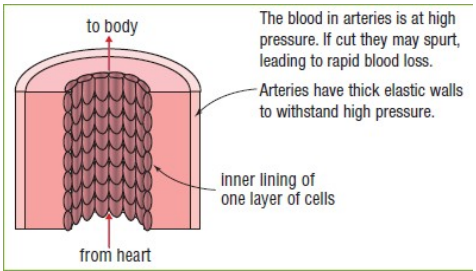
Platelets are tiny cells with no _____ . They are involved in the _____ ___ _____ . Platelets form sticky _____ that plug up damaged _____ _____ .

Blood Vessels

Blood travels along tubes called blood vessels. There are three types of blood vessels;

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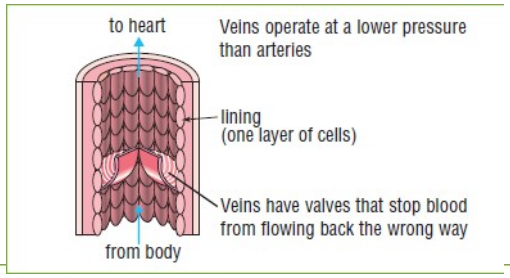
Arteries



Arteries carry _____ blood away from the heart to _____ and _____ . The walls of arteries are _____ , _____ and _____ . Blood is pumped through arteries under pressure. Smaller arteries are called arterioles.

Veins

Veins return _____ blood from the body to the heart. They have thinner, more _____ walls than arteries. Veins have _____ to stop the blood flowing _____ . Smaller veins are called venules.



Capillaries

Capillaries are the smallest blood vessels and they are only one cell thick. The allow transport of _____ and _____ into body cells and transport _____ out of body cells.

